MODULE 3

Rise to the Occasion

"When we least expect it, life sets us a challenge to test our courage and willingness to change."

— PAULO COELHO

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What does it take to meet a challenge?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**Rent Party Jazz** · William Miller	HISTORICAL FICTION
2	**The Galveston Hurricane of 1900**	NARRATIVE NONFICTION
3	**Catch Me If You Can** · Carol Schaffner	PLAY · DRAMA
4	**My Diary from Here to There** · Amada Irma Pérez	AUTOBIOGRAPHICAL FICTION

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A · Vocabulary (23) ..... p. 2

B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 5

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 11

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 14

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 3 · Rise to the Occasion · Grade 4 · 23 Items

CCSS L.4.4 · L.4.5 · L.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.4.6

endurance

If you have **endurance**, you can —

- ◯ **A.** finish a task in just a few seconds.
- ◯ **B.** remember many facts at once.
- ◯ **C.** keep doing something for a long time.
- ◯ **D.** change your plans whenever you wish.

Q2 L.4.5 TRAP

confront

When you **confront** a problem, you —

- ◯ **A.** face it and deal with it.
- ◯ **B.** run away from it as fast as you can.
- ◯ **C.** pretend that it is not there.
- ◯ **D.** hand it to someone else to solve.

Q3 L.4.6

dauntless

Someone who is **dauntless** —

- ◯ **A.** gets tired very easily.
- ◯ **B.** has no fears and does not give up.
- ◯ **C.** likes to be alone all the time.
- ◯ **D.** forgets things quickly.

Q4 L.4.6

dedication

If someone has **dedication** for something, that person has shown —

- **A.** a wish to quit soon.
- **B.** fear of trying it.
- **C.** a dislike for it.
- **D.** strong commitment to it.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · RENT PARTY JAZZ

Q5 L.4.5 TRAP

auction

At an **auction**, items are —

- **A.** sold to the person who offers the most money.
- **B.** given away for free to everyone.
- **C.** traded for an equal item.
- **D.** locked away so no one can buy them.

Q6 L.4.4

drifting

The music came **drifting** down the street. If something is **drifting**, it is —

- **A.** stopping all at once.
- **B.** getting much louder very fast.
- **C.** moving slowly without much direction.
- **D.** sinking straight to the ground.

Q7 L.4.5 TRAP

damp

The morning air felt **damp**. Something that is **damp** is —

- **A.** completely dry and dusty.
- **B.** a little wet.
- **C.** very bright and sunny.
- **D.** warm and cozy.

Q8 L.4.5 TRAP

spare

Sonny needed money he could **spare**. Something you can **spare** is —

- ◯ **A.** the only one you own.
- ◯ **B.** something you borrowed.
- ◯ **C.** something you lost.
- ◯ **D.** extra, so you do not really need it.

Q9 L.4.4

verses

The **verses** of a song are —

- ◯ **A.** the different sections that usually change throughout the song.
- ◯ **B.** the instruments that play the tune.
- ◯ **C.** the people who sing it together.
- ◯ **D.** the stage where it is performed.

Q10 L.4.4

chorus

The **chorus** of a song is the part that —

- ◯ **A.** is played only at the very end.
- ◯ **B.** no one is allowed to sing.
- ◯ **C.** is repeated after each verse.
- ◯ **D.** changes completely every time.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · RENT PARTY JAZZ (CONTINUED)

Q11 L.4.4

brimming

By the end of the night, the bucket was **brimming** with coins. If something is **brimming**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** almost empty.
- ◯ **B.** full and about to overflow.
- ◯ **C.** cracked down the middle.
- ◯ **D.** half the usual size.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE GALVESTON HURRICANE OF 1900

Q12 L.4.4

surge

The storm **surge** easily flooded the island that Galveston called home. If there is a **surge** of water, there is —

- ◯ **A.** a sudden large increase in its depth.
- ◯ **B.** a slow, steady drop in its level.
- ◯ **C.** a change in its color.
- ◯ **D.** a layer of ice on top of it.

Q13 L.4.4

perished

About 8,000 people **perished** in the storm. When people **perished**, they —

- ◯ **A.** were rescued safely.
- ◯ **B.** moved to a new town.
- ◯ **C.** died.
- ◯ **D.** hid until it was over.

Q14 L.4.4

debris

Milton escaped by "running and swimming from one lot of **debris** to another." **Debris** is —

- ◯ **A.** fresh rain that has just fallen.
- ◯ **B.** warm, calm air.
- ◯ **C.** a list of safety rules.
- ◯ **D.** the pieces of something that was broken or destroyed.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · CATCH ME IF YOU CAN

Q15 L.4.4

adoringly

The young men looked at Atalanta **adoringly**. If you act **adoringly**, you act with —

- ◯ **A.** anger and impatience.
- ◯ **B.** a lot of love and admiration.
- ◯ **C.** boredom and tiredness.
- ◯ **D.** fear and worry.

Q16 L.4.5 TRAP

capable

Atalanta said she was **capable** of choosing for herself. If a person is **capable**, he or she —

- ◯ **A.** needs others to do everything.
- ◯ **B.** refuses to try anything new.
- ◯ **C.** is too young to decide.
- ◯ **D.** has the skill or ability to do something.

Q17 L.4.4

spectators

Spectators are people who —

- ◯ **A.** watch an event, such as a sports competition.
- ◯ **B.** compete in the race themselves.
- ◯ **C.** hand out the prizes at the end.
- ◯ **D.** build the track before the race.

Q18 L.4.5 TRAP

disbelief

The king shook his head in **disbelief**. If you feel **disbelief**, you —

- ◯ **A.** are completely sure it is true.
- ◯ **B.** feel proud and pleased.
- ◯ **C.** cannot believe that something is true.
- ◯ **D.** already expected it to happen.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · MY DIARY FROM HERE TO THERE

Q19 L.4.5 TRAP

burst

Amada wrote, "If I don't write this all down I'll **burst**!" Here, to feel like you will **burst** means you —

- ◯ **A.** feel so much emotion that it is hard to hold it in.
- ◯ **B.** pop like a balloon full of air.
- ◯ **C.** fall fast asleep.
- ◯ **D.** feel nothing at all.

Q20 L.4.4

opportunities

The family hoped for new **opportunities**. If you have **opportunities**, you have —

- **A.** rules you must follow.
- **B.** problems you must solve.
- **C.** chores you must finish.
- **D.** chances to make something good happen.

Q21 L.4.4

immigration

Immigration is the process of —

- **A.** taking a short vacation.
- **B.** coming to live in a new country.
- **C.** visiting a museum for a day.
- **D.** selling a family's belongings.

Q22 L.4.4

refugees

Refugees are people who —

- **A.** travel for fun and adventure.
- **B.** are visiting relatives for the summer.
- **C.** have to leave their home country because of war or other serious problems.
- **D.** work for the government of a country.

Q23 L.4.4

amazing

If something is **amazing**, it is —

- **A.** very surprising and wonderful.
- **B.** dull and ordinary.
- **C.** small and unimportant.
- **D.** hard to understand.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 3 · Rise to the Occasion · Grade 4 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.4.1 · RL.4.2 · RL.4.3 · RL.4.5 · RL.4.6 · RI.4.1 · RI.4.2 · RI.4.3 · RI.4.5 · RI.4.6 · RI.4.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · Rent Party Jazz

HISTORICAL FICTION · WILLIAM MILLER · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.4.2

What is "Rent Party Jazz" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How to learn to play the trumpet.
- ◯ **B.** A boy who runs away from his home in New Orleans.
- ◯ **C.** A boy and his neighbors who throw a party to raise the rent money his family needs.
- ◯ **D.** A famous singer who moves to Mississippi.

Q2 RL.4.3

Why does Sonny go to work for the coal man each morning before school?

- ◯ **A.** He and Mama need the extra money the job brings in.
- ◯ **B.** He wants to learn how to drive the coal wagon.
- ◯ **C.** He is trying to win a prize at school.
- ◯ **D.** He does not like to stay in his warm bed.

Q3 RL.4.3

What problem does the family face after Mama loses her job?

- ◯ **A.** They cannot find the way back to their house.
- ◯ **B.** Sonny is no longer allowed to go to school.
- ◯ **C.** The coal man refuses to pay Sonny.
- ◯ **D.** They may not be able to pay the rent, and the rent man could take their belongings.

Q4 RL.4.3

How does Smilin' Jack help Sonny's family?

- ◯ **A.** He lends them money to pay the rent man.
- ◯ **B.** He suggests a rent party and plays his trumpet at it for free.
- ◯ **C.** He gives Mama a new job at his club.
- ◯ **D.** He buys their house so they can stay.

Q5 RL.4.1

How does a rent party raise money, according to Smilin' Jack?

- ◯ **A.** Guests pay a fee at the door to come inside.
- ◯ **B.** The host sells food and drinks all night long.
- ◯ **C.** Neighbors gather, music plays, and people drop money into a bucket.
- ◯ **D.** The city pays families who hold a party.

Q6 RL.4.6

Why does Smilin' Jack refuse to keep the extra money at the end of the party?

- ◯ **A.** He thinks the family did not earn it.
- ◯ **B.** He is angry that so few people came.
- ◯ **C.** He plans to come back and collect it later.
- ◯ **D.** He says the money belongs to anyone who needs it, and that playing was its own reward.

Q7 RL.4.3

By the end of the night, how does the bucket of money show that the party worked?

- ◯ **A.** It is empty because no one gave anything.
- ◯ **B.** It is brimming with coins, more than enough for the rent.
- ◯ **C.** It holds only a few coins.
- ◯ **D.** It is filled with letters instead of money.

Q8 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN theme, or message, of "Rent Party Jazz"?

- ◯ **A.** Sonny rides with the coal man each morning and earns ten cents a day before going to school.
- ◯ **B.** Smilin' Jack came from Mississippi and has played his horn all around the country, even up North.
- ◯ **C.** Mama packed fancy fish for a penny a can until she was let go from the canning factory.
- ◯ **D.** People can overcome hard times when a community works together, and helping others is its own reward.

Selection 2 · The Galveston Hurricane of 1900

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.4.2

What is "The Galveston Hurricane of 1900" mainly about?

- **A.** How a deadly hurricane struck Galveston, Texas, in 1900 and how the city recovered afterward.
- **B.** How a busy port in Texas grew into the largest city in the whole United States.
- **C.** How a family traveled from North Dakota to Texas to open a new store by the sea.
- **D.** How scientists today use special tools to predict the exact path of every storm.

Q10 RI.4.3

According to the text, why was Galveston in more danger than the mainland during a storm?

- **A.** It was far from the Gulf of Mexico, so no ships could bring help in time.
- **B.** Its houses were all built low to the ground without any foundations.
- **C.** It was on a barrier island, which takes the impact of damaging winds and storm surge.
- **D.** Its people had been warned that the storm was heading straight for their city.

Q11 RI.4.3

According to the text, what happened when the hurricane struck on September 8, 1900?

- **A.** The storm passed quickly, and only a few houses lost their roofs.
- **B.** Waves rose twenty feet within hours, and about 8,000 people perished.
- **C.** The storm turned back out to sea before it ever reached the island.
- **D.** The winds stayed gentle, and the storm brought only a light rain.

Q12 RI.4.3

According to the text, why weren't the people of Galveston prepared for the hurricane?

- **A.** Scientists predicted the storm would go along the East Coast, but it changed direction.
- **B.** The storm arrived late at night, when everyone in the city was fast asleep.
- **C.** The people believed that a hurricane could never reach the Gulf of Mexico.
- **D.** The city had already built a seawall, so people believed they were safe.

Q13 RI.4.3

In his letter, Milton Elford explains why his family went to the house across the street. What was their reason?

- **A.** Their own house had already been washed away by the rising waves.
- **B.** Their neighbors had asked them to come over and help build rafts.
- **C.** They thought a large house on a high brick foundation would be safer.
- **D.** They hoped to find a boat there that could carry them to Houston.

Q14 RI.4.6

Paragraph 6 begins, "We left our house about 4 o'clock thinking we would be safer in a larger house." How do you know this part is a firsthand account?

- ◯ **A.** It uses words such as he, his, and their to tell about the family.
- ◯ **B.** It is told by Milton, who lived through the storm, using words like we and us.
- ◯ **C.** It gives facts about the whole city, such as the number of homes destroyed.
- ◯ **D.** It was written by someone who learned about the storm many years later.

Q15 RI.4.5

This selection uses the headings "The Storm's Arrival" and "After the Storm." How is the information in the selection mainly organized?

- ◯ **A.** By comparing two different storms that hit the same city.
- ◯ **B.** As a set of steps that explain how to stay safe in a storm.
- ◯ **C.** From the least important fact to the most important fact.
- ◯ **D.** In time order, telling what happened before, during, and after the storm.

Q16 RI.4.8 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea the author wants readers to understand in "The Galveston Hurricane of 1900"?

- ◯ **A.** Wind speeds grew to 135 miles per hour, and it was a Category 4 hurricane.
- ◯ **B.** The 1900 hurricane was a terrible disaster for Galveston, but the city slowly rebuilt.
- ◯ **C.** Milton Elford stuck his head and shoulders in an old tool chest in the debris.
- ◯ **D.** Buildings were raised up to 17 feet by pumping sand beneath the foundations.

Selection 3 · Catch Me If You Can

PLAY (DRAMA) · CAROL SCHAFFNER · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.4.2

What is the play "Catch Me If You Can" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A princess who races for her own freedom instead of being married off.
- ◯ **B.** A king who builds the fastest ship in the land.
- ◯ **C.** A group of messengers who get lost on a journey.
- ◯ **D.** A race to win a golden trophy in a city.

Q18 RL.4.3

Why does King Henry decide to hold a race?

- ◯ **A.** He wants to find the fastest horse in the land.
- ◯ **B.** He hopes to win a prize for himself.
- ◯ **C.** He has decided the winner of the race may marry his daughter, Atalanta.
- ◯ **D.** He wants to teach the young men how to run.

Q19 RL.4.3

What does Atalanta really want to do with her life?

- ◯ **A.** Marry the fastest runner in the kingdom.
- ◯ **B.** Go out and see the world and make her own choices.
- ◯ **C.** Become queen and rule the land.
- ◯ **D.** Stay home and never leave the palace.

Q20 RL.4.3

After Young John nearly ties Atalanta in the race, what does he choose to do?

- ◯ **A.** He demands to marry her at once.
- ◯ **B.** He challenges her to race again.
- ◯ **C.** He asks the king for a different prize.
- ◯ **D.** He refuses to claim her as a prize and asks only to get to know her.

Q21 RL.4.5

"Catch Me If You Can" is written as a play. Which feature shows that it is a play rather than a story?

- ◯ **A.** It has a cast of characters and lines of dialogue with stage directions in parentheses.
- ◯ **B.** It is divided into chapters with page numbers.
- ◯ **C.** It uses headings, charts, and captions.
- ◯ **D.** It is written as a list of facts.

Q22 RL.4.6

What is the role of the Narrator in the play?

- ◯ **A.** The Narrator runs in the race against Atalanta.
- ◯ **B.** The Narrator is the king's chief advisor.
- ◯ **C.** The Narrator tells the audience about the action and helps move the story along.
- ◯ **D.** The Narrator only announces the winner at the end.

Q23 RL.4.3

How do Atalanta and Young John each spend their time at the very end of the play?

- **A.** They get married and stay in the palace.
- **B.** They set off to travel and see the world, each visiting a different place.
- **C.** They take over the kingdom together.
- **D.** They never speak to each other again.

Q24 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN theme, or message, of "Catch Me If You Can"?

- **A.** Atalanta can run as fast as the wind, and she is also bright, clever, and able to fix almost anything.
- **B.** The race takes place once upon a time in a kingdom, and messengers are sent out to announce it.
- **C.** Young John went out for a run each evening until he could run as fast as the wind.
- **D.** A person should be free to make their own choices, and respect beats being treated as a prize.

Selection 4 · My Diary from Here to There

AUTOBIOGRAPHICAL FICTION · AMADA IRMA PÉREZ · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.4.2

What is "My Diary from Here to There" mostly about?

- **A.** A girl named Amada whose family moves from Mexico to the United States, told through her diary.
- **B.** A class trip to a museum in Los Angeles.
- **C.** A girl who learns to play in a band.
- **D.** A family that opens a restaurant in Juarez.

Q26 RL.4.3

Why must Amada's family leave their home in Juarez?

- **A.** They want to live closer to the beach.
- **B.** Their house is too small for the family.
- **C.** Papa lost his job, and there is no work for him there.
- **D.** They are going on a long vacation.

Q27 RL.4.3

What does Papa tell Amada to help her feel brave about the move?

- **A.** He tells her she is stronger than she thinks, and that he made it through a big change too.
- **B.** He promises they will move back home very soon.
- **C.** He tells her not to worry about anything ever.
- **D.** He says she will not have to go to a new school.

Q28 RL.4.3

What does Amada keep to help her remember her best friend, Michi?

- **A.** A photograph of their school.
- **B.** A heart-shaped stone they exchanged, and she writes letters to her.
- **C.** A drawing of the border.
- **D.** A song they wrote together.

Q29 RL.4.6

The story is told as Amada's diary entries, using the word "I." How does this point of view help the reader?

- **A.** It keeps Amada's feelings a secret from the reader.
- **B.** It tells the story from Papa's point of view.
- **C.** It lets the reader share Amada's private thoughts, fears, and hopes as she lives through the move.
- **D.** It makes the events feel like they never really happened.

Q30 RL.4.3

What does Amada come to understand about herself by the end of her diary?

- **A.** That she would rather have stayed behind alone.
- **B.** That she does not need her family anymore.
- **C.** That she will never make new friends.
- **D.** That she is strong wherever she is — in Mexico, in the States, anywhere.

Q31 RL.4.3

How does crossing the border in Tijuana make Amada feel, and what helps her get through it?

- **A.** It feels easy, and she crosses all by herself.
- **B.** It feels calm, and a guard carries her across.
- **C.** It feels crowded and scary, but the family holds hands and stays together the whole way.
- **D.** It feels boring, so she falls asleep.

Q32 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN theme, or message, of "My Diary from Here to There"?

- **A.** Amada has five brothers named Mario, Victor, Héctor, Raúl, and Sergio.
- **B.** The family stops in Mexicali, where the relatives welcome them with a feast of tamales and hot chocolate.
- **C.** Papa was born in Arizona and moved back to Mexico with his family when he was six years old.
- **D.** With the love of family and a record of one's memories, a person finds the strength to face a hard change and start a new life.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 3 · Rise to the Occasion · Grade 4

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about what it takes to meet a challenge. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"Rent Party Jazz,"** Sonny's family faces a hard challenge. Show the PROBLEM they face, then explain HOW the community and Smilin' Jack help them rise to the occasion.

MEETING THE CHALLENGE · RENT PARTY JAZZ

THE PROBLEM	WHAT THEY DO	HOW IT ENDS

Smilin' Jack says the money "belongs to anybody who needs it." What does this show about helping others? Use the word *responsibility* in your answer.

Q2 Causation DOK 3

In **"The Galveston Hurricane of 1900,"** one thing leads to another. Trace the CHAIN of cause and effect from where Galveston sat to the damage the storm caused, then explain how the storm changed the city.

CAUSE AND EFFECT · GALVESTON, 1900

CAUSE 1 · THE ISLAND

why was the island hit so hard?

CAUSE 2 · STORM SURGE

what did the water and winds do?

EFFECT · ON THE CITY

what happened to homes and people?

How did the people of Galveston rebuild after the storm? Why was the city "forever changed"?

Q3 Perspective DOK 3

In **"Catch Me If You Can,"** Atalanta and her father, King Henry, see her future very differently. Show what EACH of them wants, then explain how Atalanta rises to the occasion.

TWO POINTS OF VIEW · CATCH ME IF YOU CAN

WHAT THE KING WANTS	WHAT ATALANTA WANTS

Young John ties Atalanta but will not claim her as a prize. What does his choice show about respect? Explain.

Q4 Connection DOK 3

In **"My Diary from Here to There,"** Amada is afraid of a big change but slowly grows stronger. Compare how she feels at the START of her journey with how she feels by the END.

FROM FEAR TO STRENGTH · MY DIARY FROM HERE TO THERE

AMADA AT THE START	AMADA BY THE END

How do Amada's family and her memories of home help her find the strength to meet this challenge? Explain.

Q5 Perseverance DOK 4

Essential Question: What does it take to meet a challenge? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What challenge is faced here, and what does it take to meet it?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What challenge is faced here, and what does it take to meet it?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 3 · Rise to the Occasion · Grade 4

MAP RIT 200 → 220 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Long Climb

Maya had wanted to reach the top of Eagle Hill all summer. The trail was long and steep, and the first time she tried, she gave up halfway and walked back down. That night she felt upset with herself. The next morning she decided to try again, but this time she made a plan. She would walk slowly and rest whenever she felt tired. She filled a bottle with water and packed a small snack. As she climbed, her legs began to ache, and once she almost turned around. Instead, she stopped, took a deep breath, and kept going one step at a time. Near the top, the path grew rocky, but Maya did not quit. When she finally reached the very top, she could see the whole town spread out below her like a tiny map. She felt proud, not only of the view, but of herself for not giving up. Maya learned that meeting a hard challenge takes patience, a good plan, and the courage to keep trying.

170 WORDS · LEXILE 500–560L · RIT 200–206

Q1 RIT 200 | Lexile 500L | Key Detail

What did Maya want to do all summer?

- ◯ **A.** Reach the top of Eagle Hill.
- ◯ **B.** Learn to swim in a lake.
- ◯ **C.** Win a running race.
- ◯ **D.** Build a tree house.

Q2 RIT 202 | Lexile 520L | Cause & Effect

Why did Maya feel upset with herself after her first try?

- ◯ **A.** She forgot her water bottle.
- ◯ **B.** She gave up halfway and walked back down.
- ◯ **C.** She fell and hurt her knee.
- ◯ **D.** She climbed the wrong hill.

Q3 RIT 203 · Lexile 530L · Key Detail

What plan did Maya make for her second try?

- ◯ **A.** To run as fast as she could the whole way.
- ◯ **B.** To ask a friend to carry her pack.
- ◯ **C.** To walk slowly, rest when tired, and bring water and a snack.
- ◯ **D.** To climb only when it was raining.

Q4 RIT 205 · Lexile 550L · Inference

When the path grew rocky near the top but Maya "did not quit," this shows that she —

- ◯ **A.** was no longer interested in the view.
- ◯ **B.** had forgotten why she was climbing.
- ◯ **C.** wanted someone else to finish for her.
- ◯ **D.** had learned to keep going even when something is hard.

Q5 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Long Climb"?

- ◯ **A.** Meeting a hard challenge takes patience, a plan, and the courage to keep trying.
- ◯ **B.** Maya packed a water bottle and a small snack before her second try up the hill.
- ◯ **C.** From the very top of Eagle Hill, Maya could see the whole town spread out below her.
- ◯ **D.** The first time Maya tried the trail, she gave up halfway and walked back down.

Passage 2 · The Storm Spotters

Long before there were satellites in space, people had no way to know that a big storm was coming. A storm could strike a town with almost no warning. Today, weather scientists work hard to keep people safe. They use many tools to track storms as they form and grow. Tall towers send out invisible signals called radar that bounce off raindrops and show where rain is falling. Floating buoys in the ocean measure the height of the waves and the speed of the wind. Some scientists even fly small planes straight into a storm to gather facts that no machine on the ground can collect. All of this information is sent to a weather center, where experts study it and decide whether a town is in danger. If a dangerous storm is on the way, they send out a warning so families can prepare or move to a safer place. Thanks to these storm spotters and their tools, fewer people are caught by surprise when a powerful storm arrives.

170 WORDS · LEXILE 560–620L · RIT 206–211

Q6 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Key Detail

Long ago, why could a storm strike a town with almost no warning?

- ◯ **A.** Storms moved much faster in the past.
- ◯ **B.** There were no satellites or tools to track storms.
- ◯ **C.** People did not care about the weather.
- ◯ **D.** Towns were built too close to the sea.

Q7 RIT 208 · Lexile 580L · Key Detail

What do floating buoys in the ocean measure?

- ◯ **A.** The color of the water.
- ◯ **B.** The number of fish below.
- ◯ **C.** The height of the waves and the speed of the wind.
- ◯ **D.** The depth of the sand on the beach.

Q8 RIT 209 · Lexile 590L · Cause & Effect

Why do experts at the weather center study the information they receive?

- ◯ **A.** To find the best place to go fishing.
- ◯ **B.** To decide what to name each storm.
- ◯ **C.** To measure how deep the ocean is.
- ◯ **D.** To decide whether a town is in danger and needs a warning.

Q9 RIT 210 · Lexile 600L · Inference

Why is it brave for scientists to fly small planes straight into a storm?

- ◯ **A.** The storm is dangerous, but the facts they gather can help keep people safe.
- ◯ **B.** The planes can only fly at night.
- ◯ **C.** They are trying to make the storm stop.
- ◯ **D.** They want to take pictures for fun.

Q10 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Storm Spotters"?

- ◯ **A.** Tall towers send out radar signals that bounce off raindrops to show where rain is falling.
- ◯ **B.** Weather scientists use many tools to track storms and warn people so they stay safe.
- ◯ **C.** Some scientists fly small planes straight into a storm to gather facts from inside it.
- ◯ **D.** Floating buoys in the ocean measure the height of the waves and the speed of the wind.

Passage 3 · Wilma Rudolph Runs

When Wilma Rudolph was a little girl, almost no one believed she would ever walk well, let alone run. As a child she became very sick and lost the use of one of her legs. For years she had to wear a heavy brace just to stand. Doctors said she might never walk without it. But Wilma was determined. Every day her family helped her exercise her weak leg, rubbing it and moving it for hours. Slowly, with great effort, Wilma began to walk. Then she began to run. By the time she was a teenager, she was one of the fastest runners at her school. She practiced harder than anyone, refusing to let her early illness hold her back. In 1960, Wilma Rudolph traveled to the Olympic Games and won three gold medals in running races. The girl who once could not walk had become one of the fastest women in the world. Her story reminds us that with hard work, help from others, and a will that does not quit, people can overcome enormous challenges.

177 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 211–216

Q11 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Key Detail

What happened to Wilma Rudolph when she was a child?

- ◯ **A.** She moved to a new country.
- ◯ **B.** She won her first race at school.
- ◯ **C.** She became very sick and lost the use of one of her legs.
- ◯ **D.** She learned to swim before she could walk.

Q12 RIT 212 · Lexile 640L · Cause & Effect

How did Wilma slowly begin to walk again?

- ◯ **A.** Her family helped her exercise her weak leg every day for hours.
- ◯ **B.** A doctor gave her a new pair of shoes.
- ◯ **C.** She waited until the brace fell off on its own.
- ◯ **D.** She stopped trying and rested for years.

Q13 RIT 213 · Lexile 660L · Key Detail

What did Wilma Rudolph do at the Olympic Games in 1960?

- ◯ **A.** She carried the Olympic torch.
- ◯ **B.** She won three gold medals in running races.
- ◯ **C.** She coached the other runners.
- ◯ **D.** She watched the races from the stands.

Q14 RIT 215 · Lexile 680L · Vocabulary

The passage says Wilma "was determined." In this sentence, **determined** means —

- ◯ **A.** tired and ready to rest.
- ◯ **B.** firmly decided to do something and unwilling to give up.
- ◯ **C.** unsure about what to do next.
- ◯ **D.** afraid of trying anything new.

Q15 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Wilma Rudolph Runs"?

- ◯ **A.** As a child, Wilma had to wear a heavy brace just to be able to stand.
- ◯ **B.** Every day Wilma's family rubbed and moved her weak leg for hours to help her.
- ◯ **C.** At the 1960 Olympic Games, Wilma Rudolph won three gold medals in running races.
- ◯ **D.** With hard work, help, and a will that does not quit, people can overcome huge challenges.

Passage 4 · The New Student

On his first day at Lincoln School, Diego felt his heart pound. He had just moved from a town far away, and everything here was strange. The hallways were crowded with students he did not know, and he could not find his classroom. Worst of all, he worried that no one would want to be his friend. At lunch he sat alone, staring at his tray. Then a girl named Priya sat down across from him. "You're new, right?" she asked with a smile. "I was new last year. It was hard at first, but it gets better." She introduced him to her friends, and soon Diego was laughing along with the group. By the end of the week, he knew his way around the school and had a place to sit at lunch. Diego realized that meeting the challenge of a new school did not mean facing it completely alone. Sometimes the bravest thing is to accept a kind hand, and the kindest thing is to offer one. A single friendly act had turned a scary day into the start of something good.

184 WORDS · LEXILE 700–800L · RIT 216–220

Q16 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Key Detail

Why was everything at Lincoln School strange to Diego?

- ◯ **A.** He had just moved from a town far away.
- ◯ **B.** He had been sick for a long time.
- ◯ **C.** He was much older than the other students.
- ◯ **D.** He had never been to school before.

Q17 RIT 217 · Lexile 720L · Cause & Effect

Why did Diego sit alone at lunch on his first day?

- ◯ **A.** He wanted to be by himself.
- ◯ **B.** He did not know anyone and worried no one would want to be his friend.
- ◯ **C.** The other tables were all full.
- ◯ **D.** He had forgotten his lunch at home.

Q18 RIT 218 · Lexile 740L · Key Detail

How did Priya help Diego feel better?

- ◯ **A.** She showed him how to find his bus.
- ◯ **B.** She gave him part of her lunch.
- ◯ **C.** She sat with him, told him it gets better, and introduced him to her friends.
- ◯ **D.** She helped him with his homework.

Q19 RIT 219 | Lexile 770L | Inference

Why does the passage say "the bravest thing is to accept a kind hand"?

- ◯ **A.** Because Diego should have stayed home instead.
- ◯ **B.** Because making friends is against the rules.
- ◯ **C.** Because Priya was the only kind student in the school.
- ◯ **D.** Because it can take courage to let others help you when you feel alone.

Q20 RIT 220 | Lexile 800L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The New Student"?

- ◯ **A.** On his first day, Diego could not find his classroom in the crowded hallways.
- ◯ **B.** Priya sat down across from Diego and told him she had been new last year.
- ◯ **C.** By the end of the week, Diego knew his way around the school.
- ◯ **D.** A hard challenge like a new school can be met with courage and the kindness of others.